

To configure AEM Universal Editor with a decoupled React app, you need to perform the following main steps: set up your local development environment (AEM, React app, Universal Editor Service), add the Universal Editor core library and metadata to your React app, and instrument your React components using specific `data-aue-*` attributes. [🔗](#)

Prerequisites

- A running local AEM development instance (AEM SDK) with HTTPS enabled.
- Node.js (version ≥ 20) installed.
- A decoupled React application running on a local development server. [🔗](#)

Step 1: Set Up Local Environment [🔗](#)

1. **Run the React app over HTTPS:** The Universal Editor requires the editable application to be loaded over HTTPS. Use a tool like `local-ssl-proxy` for local development.

bash

```
npm install -g local-ssl-proxy
local-ssl-proxy --source 3001 --target 3000
# Your React app will now be accessible at https://localhost:3001
```

2. **Set Up the Local Universal Editor Service:** Download the `universal-editor-service.cjs` from the Adobe Software Distribution Portal, configure it with environment variables for port and certificates, and run it. This local service connects the Universal Editor with your AEM instance.
3. **Trust Self-Signed Certificates:** Ensure your browser and development environment trust the self-signed certificates used for HTTPS on your local AEM and React app instances.
4. **Configure AEM for local UES:** In AEM, you might need to specify the local Universal Editor Service (UES) endpoint using a meta tag or OSGi configuration, so AEM knows where to load resources from during authoring. [🔗](#)

Step 2: Include Universal Editor Library and Metadata in React App [🔗](#)

1. **Include the core library:** Add the Universal Editor core library JavaScript file to your React application's main HTML file (`public/index.html` or similar). This can be done using a script tag or a library like `react-helmet-async` to modify the document head.

html

```
<script src="https://experience.adobe.com" async></script>
```

2. **Add Connection Metadata:** Provide connection details to your AEM instance using meta tags in the `<head>` of your HTML. This tells the Universal Editor where to fetch and save content:

html

```
<!-- Content Source: AEM connection URN -->
<meta name="urn:adobe:aue:system:aemconnection" content="https://<your-aem-author-instance>" />

<!-- Local Universal Editor Service Configuration (for local dev) -->
<meta name="urn:adobe:aue:config:service" content="https://localhost:8001">
```



Step 3: Instrument React Components

Add specific `data-aue-*` attributes to the HTML elements within your React components to make them editable. 

- `data-aue-resource` : The AEM resource path (e.g., to a Content Fragment).
- `data-aue-type` : The type of content/component (e.g., `reference`, `component`, `text`, `media`).
- `data-aue-prop` : The specific property name within the AEM resource to be edited.
- `data-aue-label` : A human-readable label for the properties panel. 

Example Instrumentation:

jsx

```
// src/components/Teams.js (example from AEM docs)
function Team({ _path, title, description }) {
  return (
    // AEM Universal Editor :: Instrumentation using data-aue-* attributes
    <div
      className="team"
      data-aue-resource={`urn:aemconnection:${_path}/jcr:content/data/master`}
      data-aue-type="reference"
      data-aue-label={title}
    >
      <h2 data-aue-prop="title" data-aue-type="text">{title}</h2>
      <p data-aue-prop="description" data-aue-type="richtext">{description}</p>
    </div>
  )
}
```

```
    </div>  
  );  
}
```

Step 4: Open in Universal Editor

1. Navigate to the Universal Editor in your browser.
2. Enter the HTTPS URL of your running React app (e.g., `https://localhost:3001`) in the **Site URL** field and click **Open**.
3. If using a local AEM SDK, you may need to provide authentication headers (Basic Auth with `admin:admin` credentials) in the Universal Editor interface's authentication settings. 

You should now be able to see the editable regions and use the properties panel to edit content which will persist back to AEM.